Nielsen

Design Assignment

Product Design Internship

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Overview

We value the intersection of data, empathy, and execution. This task assesses your ability to solve for complex constraints and translate them into polished, intuitive interfaces.

Submission Guidelines

- **Format:** Submit one public link (Figma / Slides / PDF / Video). Ensure viewing access is enabled.
- **Context:** State your assumptions clearly and provide the rationale behind your decisions.
- **Important:** Please approach this exercise from first principles. Our goal is to evaluate your independent thinking and problem solving, so we encourage you not to rely on AI tools.
- **Submission deadline:** 12 Oct 2026

What We Are Looking For

- **The "Why" Behind the "What":** The logic of your layout, typography, and element placement.
- **Environmental Empathy:** How physical realities (swaying buses, messy hands) dictate your design.
- **Information Hierarchy:** Prioritizing "signal over noise" for split-second decision-making.
- **Interaction Instinct:** Use of gestures, transitions, and feedback to improve the "feel" of the UX.
- **Attention to Detail:** Polish in edge cases and error states that make a product feel reliable.

Assignment Duration & Submission

- **Timeline:** 3 days from receipt of this brief
- **Format:** Submit as a url link (Figma / Google Slides / PDF / Video walkthrough / Any medium of your choice)
- **Access:** Ensure viewing permissions are enabled

Select one brief

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Choose one of the briefs below

1. The Conductor's Digital Companion:

Digitize the heavy, tactile thermal-printer machines used by bus conductors (e.g., BMTC or BEST) which suffer from worn buttons and unreadable screens.

The Constraints:

- **One-Handed Use:** Conductor is in a jerky bus, holding cash in one hand and a phone in the other.
- **Speed:** Select a destination and issue a ticket for 3 passengers in under 4 seconds.
- **Visibility:** Must be "glanceable" in high-glare, high-frequency environments.

Deliverables: High-fidelity UI of the ticketing flow and a breakdown of your navigation/reachability strategy.

2. The "Messy Hands" Cooking Mode:

Redesign a tablet recipe page into a "Cook-Along Mode" for users whose hands are covered in flour, oil, or water.

The Constraints:

- **Legibility:** Optimized for a viewing distance of 3–5 feet.
- **Zero-Touch Interaction:** Propose non-standard inputs (e.g., voice, camera gestures, or high-affordance "elbow" targets).
- **Cognitive Load:** Manage multiple active timers and ingredient scaling without clutter.

Deliverables: Visual design of the interface and a storyboard/prototype explaining the non-touch interaction logic.

Questions?

If you have questions about the assignment, please email us. We'll respond within 24 hours.

Remember: We're not looking for perfection. We're looking for thoughtful problem-solving, clear communication, and the ability to navigate complexity with grace.

Good luck! We're excited to see how you think. 🙂